

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥ Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠ K

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣ 6

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥ 2

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2 ♦
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣ K

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4
 ♥ 9 4 2
 ♦ 9 8 5 4 3
 ♣ Q J 5

♠ K J 9 7

♥ 8 7

♦ A K J 6 2

♣ 10 2



♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ Q J 10 3
 ♦ Q 7
 ♣ K 7 6 3

♠ Q 10 8 3

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 10

♣ A 9 8 4

NORTH's 1♠ bid is definitely forcing, but it is not FSF. In this one instance, all bids at the one level, the ♠ bid shows a real suit.

So SOUTH shows the 4-card support and NORTH bids game.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♣
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♥Q			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7
♥ Q 6 5 3
♦ 10 8 3
♣ A J 7 2

♠ 8 5 3 2

♥ J 8

♦ A K 9 6 4 2

♣ 3



♠ A 6 4
♥ A K 9 7 2
♦ 7
♣ K 8 6 5

♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 4

♦ Q J 5

♣ Q 10 9 4

EAST could make a Help Suit Game Try in either ♠s or ♣s. But she doesn't need the ♠ help as much as she does in ♣s, so she chooses ♣s.

WEST doesn't have a strong hand but has excellent help in ♣s so he bids the game.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

1♥

Pass

4♥

Pass

3♣

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♠K

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 8 7 2

♥ Q 7 3

♦ 2

♣ 9 6 5 2

♠ K J 10 5

♥ 10 9 6

♦ K 7

♣ A Q J 3



♠ 4 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ Q J 10 6 3

♣ 10 7 4

♠ Q 6

♥ K J 8 5

♦ A 9 8 5 4

♣ K 8

Could SOUTH bid 2♥, (FSF), even though she actually has the suit?

Perhaps, but there is no reason to do so. NORTH does not have four ♥s or he would have mentioned them before bidding ♠s.

SOUTH should ignore the ♥ suit and bid 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

Pass

1♦

Pass

1♠

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♣6

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 10 6 3
♥ K Q 9 8 5
♦ 6 3
♣ 5

♠ J 2

♥ J 3 2

♦ J 5 4 2

♣ K J 10 3



♠ Q 5 4

♥ 7 6

♦ A K 9 8

♣ A 8 7 4

♠ 9 8 7

♥ A 10 4

♦ Q 10 7

♣ Q 9 6 2

WEST cannot bid 2♥ at his second turn; that would be Fourth Suit Forcing and wouldn't show the ♥ suit at all.

With a game-forcing two-suiter he jumps to 3♥ instead. EAST recognizes that WEST must hold five ♠s and bids the ♠ game.

West	North	East	South
		1♦	Pass
1♠	Pass	2♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			
4♠ by West			
Lead: ♥2			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 10 2
 ♥ Q 10 6 2
 ♦ 10 5 3
 ♣ A 10 7

♠ Q 8 5

♥ A 5

♦ K Q J 6 2

♣ 6 4 3



♠ A 9 4 3

♥ 9 4

♦ 8 7

♣ K Q J 8 5

♠ K 7 6

♥ K J 8 7 3

♦ A 9 4

♣ 9 2

SOUTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping NORTH has three ♥s.

NORTH does not have three ♥s and he has no other bid to make that will describe his hand any better. He cannot bid Notrump again without a ♣ stopper. So NORTH rebids the 5-card ♦ suit.

SOUTH has nowhere to go, so passes.

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦		
All Pass			
2♦ by North			
Lead: ♣K			